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Q&A with Matthew Barnard

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As equity research adapts to rapid shifts in technology, markets and client behaviour, Matt Barnard, Head of US Equity Research, is helping steer how Deutsche Bank evolves its research offering. In this edition of our Q & A series, Matt shares his perspective on the new ways clients are consuming research, his outlook for US markets, and what it's like leading research teams through a period of significant change.

Q: You've spoken about the equity research landscape undergoing a fundamental shift. What has changed most in how clients discover, engage with and use research today?

AI is fundamentally changing how clients consume sell-side research. As information becomes more easily accessible through AI tools, the value of differentiated insights from trusted sources has moved higher up the value chain. Investors are increasingly using AI to discover new ideas and challenge consensus views more quickly and efficiently. This allows them to filter out noise and spend more time engaging in deeper, more meaningful conversations with our Deutsche Bank research analysts.

Q: Against a complex backdrop for US geopolitics and policy, how do you currently assess the outlook for US markets – and which themes matter most for clients as we move through 2026?

Geopolitical developments in the US and globally continue to be a significant driver of volatility across risk assets. Deutsche Bank research's macro and strategy teams have consistently taken bold, often counter-consensus views, which are especially valuable in this environment. While conflicts in the Middle East will likely continue to create ripple effects across markets, the underlying fundamentals for US equities remain relatively strong. The rapid acceleration of AI adoption – and the associated capital investment – remains a key thematic focus for clients, both in the US and globally.

Q: You now lead teams through a period of rapid change. What do you find most rewarding about working in research management at this point in the cycle?

At its core, the role of an equity research analyst is to form forward-looking views with imperfect information. The strongest analysts thrive in periods of uncertainty and rapid change, identifying emerging trends and uncovering new investment opportunities early. From a management perspective, the



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most rewarding part of my role is seeing some of the brightest minds in research stay ahead of these shifts and deliver true alpha for our clients.



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